

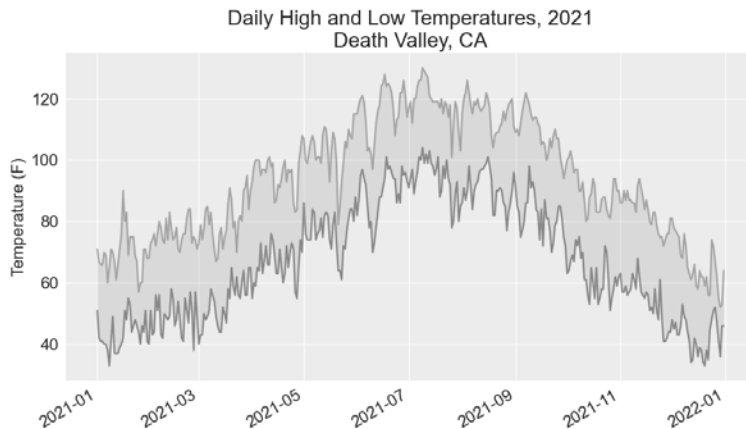


Figure 16-6: Daily high and low temperatures for Death Valley

Many datasets you work with will have missing, improperly formatted, or incorrect data. You can use the tools you learned in the first half of this book to handle these situations. Here we used a try-except-else block to handle missing data. Sometimes you'll use `continue` to skip over some data, or use `remove()` or `del` to eliminate some data after it's been extracted. Use any approach that works, as long as the result is a meaningful, accurate visualization.

Downloading Your Own Data

To download your own weather data, follow these steps:

1. Visit the NOAA Climate Data Online site at <https://www.ncdc.noaa.gov/cdo-web>. In the Discover Data By section, click **Search Tool**. In the Select a Dataset box, choose **Daily Summaries**.
2. Select a date range, and in the Search For section, choose **ZIP Codes**. Enter the ZIP code you're interested in and click **Search**.
3. On the next page, you'll see a map and some information about the area you're focusing on. Below the location name, click **View Full Details**, or click the map and then click **Full Details**.
4. Scroll down and click **Station List** to see the weather stations that are available in this area. Click one of the station names and then click **Add to Cart**. This data is free, even though the site uses a shopping cart icon. In the upper-right corner, click the cart.
5. In Select the Output Format, choose **Custom GHCN-Daily CSV**. Make sure the date range is correct and click **Continue**.